

Rulebook

WINIO CROWN SERIES

1. General Provisions	5
2. Terms and Definitions	5
3. Rights of the Organizers and Teams	7
3.1. Rights of the Organizers	7
3.2. Rights of Teams	7
4. Obligations of the Organizers and Teams	8
4.1. Obligations of the Organizers	8
4.2. Obligations of Teams	8
5. Tournament Structure	9
5.1. General Conditions	9
5.2. Open Qualifiers	9
5.3. Group Stage	10
5.4. Playoffs	10
6. Prize Pool and Distribution	10
7. Participants	11
7.1. Coaching	11
7.2. Team Roster Requirements	11
7.3. Roster Lock	12
7.4. Conflicts of Interest	12
8. Player Information	12
8.1. "Nicknames"	12
8.2. Game Account	12
8.3. Bans by Valve, ESIC or Other TOs/Platforms	12
9. Match Start	13
9.1. Punctuality	13
10. Protests and Appeals	13
10.1. Definitions	13
10.2. Protest Submission Rules	13
11. Match Broadcasting	13
11.1. Video Monitoring During Matches	13
12. Voice Communication and Recording	14
13. Penalties	14
13.1. Code of Conduct	14
13.2. Lack of Punctuality	15
13.2.1. During the Map Veto	15
13.2.2. Scheduled Match Start	16
13.3. Disciplinary Measures	16
13.3.1. Definitions and Scope of Penalties	16
13.3.2. Penalties for Repeat Offenses	17
13.3.3. Suspensions and Disqualification	17

13.3.4. Additional Penalties	17
13.4. Penalties and Consequences of Withdrawal	17
13.4.1. Withdrawal from the Tournament	17
13.5. Cheating	17
13.5.1. Prohibited Software	17
13.5.2. Misuse of Information	17
13.5.3. Penalties for Cheating	18
13.5.4. Cheat Detection Methods	18
13.6. Betting and Manipulation	18
13.7. Misleading the Organizers or Players	18
13.8. Procedure for Issuing Penalties/Warnings	18
14. Equipment	19
15. Conduct During Matches	19
Match Rules	21
1. Game Version	21
2. Match Format	21
3. Rules of Conduct	21
4. Match Preparation	21
5. Game Server	22
6. Server Settings	22
7. In-Game Commands	22
8. CS2 Round Restore Function	23
9. Official Tournament Map Pool	23
10. Map Veto Process	24
11. Map Veto Procedure	24
12. Match Rules	24
12.1. Number of Players	24
12.2. Breaks Between Matches	25
13. Use of the Pause Function	25
13.1. Technical Pauses	25
13.2. Tactical Timeouts	25
13.3. Pauses by the Tournament Organizers	25
14. Player Rules	25
14.1. Configuration Files	25
14.2. Custom Files	25
14.3. Renamed In-Game Items	26
14.4. In-Game Chat	26
14.5. Use of "Bugs"	26
14.6. Reconnecting	27

14.7. Prohibited Actions	27
15. Rule Changes	28

1. General Provisions

This Rulebook is the sole applicable Rulebook for all persons participating in Tournament matches. These rules govern the conduct of "WINIO CROWN SERIES", which is held online. The Tournament is a women's competition: only female rosters are eligible to participate. Open qualifier matches are played on the FACEIT platform, while main stage matches are played on game servers provided by the Organizer.

By submitting a Tournament Application, providing information for admission to the Tournament or participating in official Tournament matches, each Player, Coach or Team representative confirms that they have read this Rulebook, understand its contents and agree to comply with all rules, requirements and decisions of the Organizers, Referee Committee and Referees set out herein.

Submitting a Tournament Application, registering a Team for the Tournament and participating in official matches constitute full and unconditional acceptance of this Rulebook.

This Rulebook is based on Valve's current requirements for organizing Counter-Strike 2 tournaments and the provisions set out in Valve's Tournament Operator Requirements.

2. Terms and Definitions

- 2.1. Organizer** — a person or group of persons responsible for organizing, administering and running the Tournament. The Organizer may refer decisions to the RC.
- 2.2. Rulebook** — the official document containing the rules governing the Tournament.
- 2.3. Tournament** — "WINIO CROWN SERIES", held online in accordance with this Rulebook.
- 2.4. Referee Committee** — (hereinafter the RC) — "WINIO Referee Committee" — the Tournament's administrative body, comprising referees and the Head Referee approved by the Organizer. It is responsible for officiating the Tournament and resolving disputes.
- 2.5. Head Referee** — the Organizers' representative responsible for the conduct and organization of the Tournament and for making final decisions.

- 2.6. Referee** — the Organizers' representative responsible for managing the Tournament and directly overseeing its conduct in accordance with the Tournament rules.
- 2.7. Administration** — the Organizers' representatives responsible for running the Tournament and handling organizational matters.
- 2.8. Tournament Application** — a document listing the details of players and the coach for admission to the Tournament.
- 2.9. Team** — a group comprising players and a coach, admitted to the Tournament by the Organizers.
- 2.10. Player** — a person listed as such in the Tournament Application who is a member of the team's roster.
- 2.11. Coach** — a person listed as such in the Tournament Application. The Coach conducts training sessions with the players and directs their competitive activities.
- 2.12. Group Stage** — the stage of the Tournament in which 16 teams are divided into four groups of four and compete in a GSL format. The Group Stage determines which teams advance to the Playoffs.
- 2.13. Playoffs** — the stage of the Tournament in which the 8 teams advancing from the groups compete for prize-winning places in a Single Elimination format.
- 2.14. Single Elimination** — a bracket format in which a team is eliminated after its first loss.
- 2.15. GSL** — a group stage format in which each group of four teams plays two opening matches, a winners' match, a losers' match and a decider match. A team is eliminated from the group after two losses; two teams from each group advance to the next stage of the Tournament.
- 2.16. Match** — a fixture in the Tournament bracket. Match results determine the teams' positions. A Match includes regulation time and overtime.
- 2.17. Round** — a scoring unit within a map. The results of the rounds played determine the map result.
- 2.18. Map** — a scoring unit within a match. The results of the maps played determine the match result.
- 2.19. Regulation Time** — the first 24 (twenty-four) rounds of a map. Teams switch sides after 12 rounds.
- 2.20. Overtime** — a series of 6 (six) rounds with alternating sides, played until one team wins four rounds.

- 2.21. Map and Side Selection Procedure (Map Veto)** — the procedure conducted before each match to determine the maps and starting sides.
- 2.22. Official Communication Channel** — a means of communication designated by the Organizer. The official communication channels during the Tournament are: the Telegram group chat with the Organizer (direct messages are not considered an official source of information), the Discord channel provided by the Organizer, the TeamSpeak server provided by the Organizer and, for open qualifier matches, the FACEIT platform.
- 2.23. Platform** — the Tournament is held online. Open qualifier matches are played on FACEIT, while main stage matches are played on game servers provided by the Organizer or FACEIT.
- 2.24. Penalty** — a sanction for a violation of this Rulebook.
- 2.25. Penalty Point** — a unit of punishment applied to a team or player for a violation of this Rulebook.
- 2.26. Disqualification** — a sanction applied to a team or player for serious or systematic violations of this Rulebook.

3. Rights of the Organizers and Teams

3.1. Rights of the Organizers

- The rights to organize and run the Tournament belong to the Tournament Organizers. The “WINIO Referee Committee”, appointed by the Tournament Organizer, is responsible for enforcing the rules of play during the Tournament.
- Approve the Tournament Rulebook and other rules governing the terms and procedures of the Tournament.
- Provide coverage of the Tournament by broadcasting video and/or audio through any means and platforms, and by recording such broadcasts.
- Use the Tournament’s name, logo and other official designations for advertising and commercial purposes.
- Apply sanctions to a player or team that violates the Tournament rules, in accordance with the procedures set out in those rules.
- Unilaterally amend and supplement this Rulebook to clarify procedures, resolve inconsistencies and adapt to technical, organizational or legal changes. Amendments take effect upon official publication; the current version takes precedence over previously published versions.

Official Tournament representatives have full authority to represent and uphold the rules, make rulings on them and inform teams. All information provided by Tournament officials must be acknowledged and complied with immediately.

3.2. Rights of Teams

- Receive complete information in advance about Tournament procedures, match schedules, rules and other material conditions of participation.
- During play, ask referees to clarify rules and procedures relating exclusively to the current match.
- Submit protests and appeals concerning the results of a completed map and/or match in accordance with the procedures and deadlines set out in the Tournament rules.
- Request recordings of in-game communications from referees to the extent permitted by the Tournament rules, as well as Tournament logos and graphics for non-commercial use.
- Be notified of any sanctions imposed on them, including the grounds and the relevant Tournament rule.

4. Obligations of the Organizers and Teams

4.1. Obligations of the Organizers

- Arrange officiating for the Tournament, including appointing referees and other officials.
- Determine player eligibility requirements and record match results and the final Tournament standings.
- Resolve disputes arising from ambiguous interpretations of this Rulebook by clarifying the Tournament rules.
- Ensure that Tournament matches are held online, including providing game servers and a TeamSpeak voice communication server, and conducting open qualifiers on FACEIT.
- Inform Teams in a timely manner through the Official Communication Channels about the Tournament schedule, match times, technical requirements and other organizational matters.
- Perform other duties related to organizing and running the Tournament.

4.2. Obligations of Teams

By participating in the Tournament, players undertake to:

- Know, observe and comply with this Rulebook and all other Tournament rules.
- Uphold the principles of sportsmanship (respect and honesty) and conduct themselves appropriately in accordance with generally accepted standards of behavior and fair competition.
- Provide the Organizers with accurate, current and complete information about themselves and their team's roster, and promptly notify them of any changes to that information.
- At the request of the Organizers, Head Referee or referees, verify their identity and any other information required for admission to the Tournament.
- Comply without objection with lawful instructions from the Organizers, referees and other Tournament officials.
- Cooperate with checks, including reviews of accounts, equipment, in-game logs, communication recordings and other data related to participation in the Tournament.
- Use default agent skins and refrain from using renamed in-game items whose names violate the Tournament rules.
- Use the nicknames listed in the Tournament Application, with the exact same language layout and characters.
- Independently monitor information published in the Official Communication Channels, including the Tournament schedule, match times, delays and other organizational announcements.
- Be ready to start the match at the time specified by the Organizers or referees and play the match in full without unjustified pauses.
- Be responsible for keeping their own computer equipment and peripherals in working order and maintaining a stable internet connection, and comply with the match conduct rules set out in this Rulebook.

Players and coaches are prohibited from publicly disseminating information that could damage the reputation of the Organizers, Tournament partners or the Tournament itself. All comments, suggestions and complaints must be submitted exclusively through the official internal communication channels.

5. Tournament Structure

5.1. General

Format: online.

The Tournament is held for women's teams.

Number of teams in the main stage — 16.

Dates: open qualifiers — 31.10.2026 — 08.11.2026; main stage — 16.11.2026 — 22.11.2026.

- There are no direct invitations or wildcard slots in the Tournament: all 16 main stage participants qualify through the open qualifiers.
- Seeding is based on the official VRS Global ranking. The filter applied is female rosters (women's lineups).
- A team's VRS ranking is calculated from the point at which its matches appear on HLTV.
- An organization's main and academy rosters may not participate in the Tournament at the same time.
- The Organizer may refuse entry to a team or player with an active VAC ban or a history of competitive integrity violations.

5.2. Open Qualifiers

Number of qualifiers — 4. All qualifiers are held online on FACEIT.

Dates:

- Qualifier No. 1 — 31 October 2026.
- Qualifier No. 2 — 1 November 2026.
- Qualifier No. 3 — 7 November 2026.
- Qualifier No. 4 — 8 November 2026.

Competition format:

- All qualifier matches are played as best-of-three (Bo3) series.
- Four teams from each qualifier advance to the main stage's Group Stage, for a total of 16 teams.
- A team that has qualified may not participate in subsequent qualifiers.

The detailed qualifier match schedule is published by the platform based on the number of registered teams.

5.3. Group Stage

Number of match days — 5.

Dates: 16.11.2026 — 20.11.2026.

Format — GSL, 16 teams, 4 groups of 4 teams:

- Opening matches, winners' matches, losers' matches and decider matches are played as best-of-three (Bo3) series.
- A team is eliminated from its group after two losses.
- The top two teams from each group advance to the Playoffs.

Group seeding is determined by the VRS Global ranking (November 2026 publication), with the female rosters filter applied. Groups are formed as follows: Group A contains seeds 1, 8, 9 and 16; Group B contains seeds 2, 7, 10 and 15; Group C contains seeds 3, 6, 11 and 14; and Group D contains seeds 4, 5, 12 and 13.

The detailed Group Stage match schedule is published by the Organizer in the Official Communication Channels.

5.4. Playoffs

Number of match days — 2.

Dates: 21.11.2026 — 22.11.2026.

Format — Single Elimination, 8 teams:

- All Playoff matches, including the Grand Final, are played as best-of-three (Bo3) series.
- The third-place match is played as a best-of-three (Bo3) series.
- The losing team is eliminated from the Tournament.

The Playoff bracket is formed based on the Group Stage results:

- Quarterfinal No. 1: 1st place in Group A — 2nd place in Group D.
- Quarterfinal No. 2: 1st place in Group C — 2nd place in Group B.
- Quarterfinal No. 3: 2nd place in Group A — 1st place in Group D.
- Quarterfinal No. 4: 2nd place in Group C — 1st place in Group B.

The detailed Playoff match schedule is published by the Organizer in the Official Communication Channels.

6. Prize Pool and Distribution

The total Tournament prize pool is \$5,000 and is distributed as follows:

- 1st place — \$2,500

- 2nd place — \$1,500
- 3rd place — \$750
- 4th place — \$250

Each penalty point received by a participant during the Tournament results in a deduction of one percent (1%) of the team's prize money. Deducted amounts are redistributed proportionally among the other teams; prize money is not forfeited in full solely due to penalty points.

Failure to comply with the Tournament rules may result in a team forfeiting part of its prize money.

All prize payments are made exclusively in United States dollars (USD). The payment method is determined by the Organizer.

Before prize money is paid, the Organizer may cancel any pending payment if indications of cheating or unfair play are discovered. If a player is under investigation on the payment date, payment is deferred until the investigation is concluded; if the investigation is not concluded within 90 (ninety) days after the Tournament ends, payment will be made.

7. Participants

Players and teams competing in "WINIO CROWN SERIES" are considered Tournament participants.

- A player may not be on the roster of more than one team participating in the Tournament at the same time.
- Player substitutions are permitted, using up to two (2) players listed in the Tournament Application. Any player substitution must be approved by the Tournament's Referee Committee.

7.1. Coaching

Teams may be accompanied by their registered Coach during matches. The Coach does not connect to the game server. The Coach joins the team's voice channel and may communicate with the players without restriction throughout the match. The Coach must comply with the general conduct rules set out in this Rulebook. All warnings to players and coaches are issued officially by the Head Referee and the RC, entered in the match report and taken into account when imposing subsequent sanctions.

7.2. Team Roster Requirements

The Tournament is held for women's teams. A team's active roster must consist of five women at all times during the Tournament.

The Organizer may verify a participant's compliance with this requirement. Where necessary, the Organizer may request supporting documents, in compliance with applicable law and personal data protection requirements.

Verification must be completed before the team's first official match. A player added to the roster during the Tournament must complete verification before appearing in an official match. If verification is not completed by the deadline set by the Organizer, the participant may not play in matches until the process is completed.

The Coach must be listed separately in the Tournament Application. A Coach may be registered as a substitute player only after completing verification.

7.3. Roster Lock

Roster lock date — 30 October 2026. The Organizer reserves the right to change the roster lock date at its discretion.

7.4. Conflicts of Interest

Players and coaches listed on a team's official roster are strictly prohibited from having any financial interest in the results or performance of any other participant or team competing in the same Tournament. At the Organizer's request, they must provide a written declaration confirming the absence of conflicts of interest, including, but not limited to, business relationships such as shared ownership, shared management or any other form of commercial affiliation with another participant.

No person or organization with direct or indirect influence or control over a participating team may directly or indirectly hold an ownership stake, shares or any other financial interest in another team competing in the same Tournament. An exception may be granted solely at the Organizer's discretion where such financial interest is clearly insignificant or unintentional.

8. Player Information

Upon request, players must submit all information requested by the Organizer, including, but not limited to: full name, contact details, date of birth, address, game account and photograph.

8.1. "Nicknames"

Players may use only their own nicknames, without any additions. In certain cases, players may include their title sponsor; they must contact the Organizers for approval in such cases.

8.2. Game Account

Participants must provide their game account details when submitting their application. A participant wishing to use a different game account must submit the new account details. Unless the Organizers authorize otherwise before the match, participants may not use an account other than the one listed in the Tournament Application.

8.3. Bans by Valve, ESIC or Other TOs/Platforms

The Tournament Organizers reserve the right to refuse entry to players with permanent or temporary bans issued by Valve, ESIC or another tournament or competitive platform.

9. Match Start

9.1. Punctuality

Teams are given a thirty (30) minute warm-up period before the match, although this period is not guaranteed. Any time spent off the game server during these thirty (30) minutes counts as part of the warm-up. All players must be connected to the game server and ready to play thirty minutes before the match starts.

A player must join the server no later than ten (10) minutes before the scheduled match start time, unless expressly instructed otherwise by the Tournament Administration.

A player must notify the Tournament Referees as early as possible if technical, personal or force majeure circumstances prevent them from joining the Tournament server on time. Mitigating circumstances and attempts to report the delay may be taken into account when imposing penalties. Participants are responsible for monitoring the Tournament schedule and announcements of changes. Violations are covered in Section 13.2.

10. Protests and Appeals

10.1. Definitions

Protest — a formal submission by a team representative during the Tournament concerning a specific in-game incident, match or other event that affected the course or outcome of the Tournament. A protest must be submitted within 3 (three) hours of the end of the match concerned.

Appeal — a formal submission by a team representative challenging a decision already made by the RC and/or the Organizers. The Organizers determine the deadlines and procedures for reviewing protests and appeals based on the nature and complexity of each case.

10.2. Protest Submission Rules

A protest must include a detailed explanation of the grounds for submission and information on how and when the issue arose. A protest may be rejected if it lacks sufficient evidence or is submitted after the deadline. Only one team representative may participate in the process. Insults and aggressive behavior during the protest process are strictly prohibited and may result in penalty points or rejection of the protest.

11. Match Broadcasting

The Organizer and Tournament partners hold all broadcasting rights. Participants may not refuse to have their matches broadcast through authorized Tournament channels and may not choose how a match is broadcast. Only the Tournament Organizers may decide not to broadcast a match.

11.1. Video Monitoring During Matches

At the Organizer's request, players must provide a webcam or other device's video feed throughout the match. Video feeds are used to monitor competitive integrity and for broadcast purposes. Players may not refuse to be filmed and must not obstruct the Organizer's work. Players must be connected to the game server and voice channel at least 10 minutes before each match.

The Administration reserves the right to use any player video feeds during all matches.

12. Voice Communication and Recording

The Tournament Organizers use "TeamSpeak" for voice communication. The Organizer uses one of its own TeamSpeak servers. Communication during matches is limited to five players and one coach. Additional Organizer staff may join the voice channel as passive listeners with their microphones muted.

The Tournament Organizer reserves the right to record all communications during matches. Players must connect to the TeamSpeak servers 20 minutes before the match starts.

13. Penalties

13.1. Code of Conduct

All participants must treat WINIO CROWN SERIES representatives, partners, spectators and other players with respect. This requirement applies to conduct in-game, on TeamSpeak/Discord, and in chats, messaging apps, comments and other media. We expect players to uphold the following values:

- Humanity: treat others as you would like to be treated.
- Integrity: be honest, committed and fair in your play.
- Respect: show respect for everyone, including teammates, participants and staff.
- Courage: show courage in competition and in standing up for what is right.

Participants must not engage in any form of harassment or hate speech. Violations of this section result in penalty points. This includes, but is not limited to:

- Hate speech, discriminatory statements, abusive behavior or verbal abuse based on sex, sexual orientation, race, nationality, disability, appearance, body type, age or religion:
 - First offense: 5 penalty points.
 - Repeat offense: 10 penalty points.
 - Particularly serious offense: disqualification of the player or team.
- Abusive behavior, toxicity or degrading treatment of players, organizers, referees, sponsors or spectators:
 - First offense: 5 penalty points.
 - Repeat offense: 10 penalty points.
 - Systematic violations: disqualification of the player or team.

- Bullying, stalking or targeted psychological pressure, in person and/or online:
 - First offense: 5 penalty points.
 - Repeat offense: 10 penalty points.
 - Systematic violations: disqualification of the player or team.
- Spam, flooding, raids, hacking and attempts to disrupt broadcasts, servers or the Tournament's public-facing resources:
 - Minor offense: 2 penalty points.
 - Intentional offense: 5 penalty points.
 - Causing substantial harm: disqualification of the team.
- Publishing or threatening to publish another person's personal data:
 - First offense: 10 penalty points.
 - Serious offense: disqualification of the team.
- Unwanted sexual attention, including sexual comments, jokes and harassment:
 - First offense: 5 penalty points.
 - Repeat offense: 10 penalty points.
 - Serious offense: disqualification of the player or team.
- Justifying or encouraging any of the above:
 - First offense: 3 penalty points.
 - Repeat offense: 6 penalty points.
 - Systematic violations: disqualification of the player or team.

All participants must behave respectfully towards the Organizer's representatives, the press, spectators, partners and other players. A team may receive no more than 1 warning; all subsequent violations result in penalty points or in-game penalties (veto penalties). Accumulating 25 penalty points results in disqualification. All warnings to players and coaches are issued officially by the Head Referee and the RC.

Example of an in-game penalty (veto penalty): "The opposing team gains the right to choose the starting side on its own map pick."

13.2. Lack of Punctuality

13.2.1. During the Map Veto

- If a team is not ready to begin the map veto within 5 (five) minutes of the scheduled start of map and side selection, it receives one (1)

penalty point and loses the right to choose the starting side on the opponent's map pick.

- If the team is still not ready to begin the veto within the next 5 (five) minutes, it receives one (1) additional penalty point.

13.2.2. Scheduled Match Start

- If a player is not ready to start the match 5 (five) minutes after the scheduled start, the team receives one (1) penalty point and, at the Organizer's discretion, the opposing team gains the right to choose the starting side on its own map pick.
- If a participant is not ready to play within 10 (ten) minutes of the scheduled start, they are considered a no-show. In this case, the Administration awards the opposing team a forfeit win on the first map of the Bo3 series.
- If a participant is not ready to play within 20 (twenty) minutes of the scheduled start, they are considered a no-show and the opposing team is awarded a forfeit win for the entire Bo3 series.
- If a player has not connected to the game server by the time specified by the Administration, they receive an official warning from the Head Referee or the RC after the first five (5) minutes of waiting; thereafter, one (1) penalty point is imposed for each further five (5) minutes of delay, up to a maximum of two (2) penalty points.
- The team must inform the Administration of the reason for its no-show. If the reason is not considered valid, the team may be banned from all of the Organizer's events for 6 months.
- The Organizer may blacklist a team for repeatedly arriving late to matches.

Mitigating circumstances and attempts to inform the referees of a delay may be taken into account when imposing penalties. The Head Referee rules on disputed situations on a case-by-case basis. These decisions are final and may not be appealed.

13.3. Disciplinary Measures

13.3.1. Definitions and Scope of Penalties

Violations of the rules during "WINIO CROWN SERIES" are subject to penalties. These may include warnings, in-game penalties (map-veto penalties), forfeit losses, suspension or disqualification of a player, coach or team, or a combination of these, depending on the incident. Participants are

notified of the penalty and given a deadline to appeal. Only the team owner or representative may submit an appeal.

The most common violations and applicable penalties are: failure to follow referees' instructions — 1 penalty point or an in-game penalty; arguing with a referee — 1 warning or an in-game penalty; insults, threats or racist statements directed at opponents, teammates or other persons involved in the Tournament — 2 warnings or in-game penalties; unsportsmanlike conduct (e.g. sabotaging matches) — at least 3 penalty points or in-game penalties; abuse of technical pauses (e.g. frequent interruptions without a valid reason) — 2 warnings or in-game penalties; leaving the game server or voice channel during a match without a referee's permission — 3 penalty points; 5 warnings — disqualification. All warnings to players and coaches are issued officially by the Head Referee and the RC and entered in the match report. The Organizer may impose penalties for repeated match delays.

13.3.2. Penalties for Repeat Offenses

All penalties set out in this Rulebook apply to first offenses. Repeat offenses are generally punished more severely than the penalties specified in the relevant section.

13.3.3. Suspensions and Disqualification

Suspensions may be imposed for very serious incidents and may apply to both participants and organizations. In the most serious cases of rule violations, participants may be disqualified from the event. Disqualified participants forfeit all prize money earned at this Tournament. In addition, the organization and its participants are banned for the remainder of the Tournament.

13.3.4. Additional Penalties

In exceptional cases, the Tournament Organizer may determine and impose other penalties not specified in this Rulebook.

13.4. Penalties and Consequences of Withdrawal

13.4.1. Withdrawal from the Tournament

If a team withdraws before the start of the first stage of the Tournament, before the Group Stage begins, it will be replaced by the next team selected according to the following criteria:

- The next-highest-placed team from the open qualifiers across all regions;

- The team with the highest VRS ranking among the teams from the closed qualifier.

If a team withdraws at a later stage, it is assigned the lowest possible placing corresponding to elimination at that stage and forfeits all prize money previously earned.

13.5. Cheating

13.5.1. Prohibited Software

Any use of software that may be regarded as cheating is strictly prohibited. The RC reserves the right to determine which software constitutes cheating.

13.5.2. Misuse of Information

Any communication during a match with persons not participating in that match is strictly prohibited, as is using information about the match from external sources, such as broadcasts.

13.5.3. Penalties for Cheating

If cheating is discovered during the Tournament, the results of the affected matches are annulled. The team will be disqualified and forfeit its prize money.

13.5.4. Cheat Detection Methods

The Tournament Organizer reserves the right to use various methods to check players and their equipment, with or without prior notice. Players may not refuse to undergo such checks.

13.6. Betting and Manipulation

To safeguard competitive integrity and prevent conflicts of interest, players, coaches and other team representatives are prohibited from directly or indirectly participating in any betting or gambling activity relating to Tournament matches.

All players and other team members are prohibited from:

- placing bets on any Tournament matches;
- organizing, accepting or facilitating bets;
- working with bookmakers, bettors or other persons to profit from betting;
- disclosing to third parties any confidential, inside or other information that could affect odds, betting outcomes or the decisions of persons placing bets;

- using any means to influence the outcome of a match for purposes unrelated to competitive success in this Tournament; this constitutes match-fixing. The most common example is deliberately losing a match to manipulate bets.
- encouraging others to engage in activities involving bets on Tournament matches. The most common example is offering an opponent money to lose deliberately.

Placing a bet on a match involving one's own team, regardless of the outcome, constitutes a serious breach of sporting ethics and results in the immediate disqualification of the player and/or team at the Organizer's discretion.

Other violations of this section are reviewed by the Referee Committee on a case-by-case basis and may result in penalty points, suspension from individual matches, annulment of results, or disqualification from the Tournament and forfeiture of prize money.

13.7. Misleading the Organizers or Players

Any attempt to deceive opponents, the Tournament Organizers or any other persons involved in organizing the Tournament is punishable by penalty points imposed on the player or team, or by disqualification and forfeiture of prize money, at the Referee Committee's discretion.

13.8. Procedure for Issuing Penalties/Warnings

1. Warnings, penalties and other disciplinary measures are imposed by the Tournament's RC in accordance with this Rulebook.
2. If a violation occurs during a match and requires immediate intervention, the RC may pause the match until the circumstances have been clarified and a decision has been made.
3. All official warnings and penalties are recorded in hard copy.
4. All official warnings or penalties are communicated to the manager or another team representative through the designated communication channels (the group chat with team representatives).
5. In disputed situations or situations not covered by this Rulebook, the Tournament's RC makes the final decision.

14. Equipment

Participants are responsible for providing the computer equipment, peripherals and internet connection required to play in Tournament matches.

A wired internet connection is recommended. Technical issues on a participant's side are not grounds for replaying a round, map or match.

The Organizer may request information about the equipment, peripherals and software being used and may prohibit any device and/or program it considers to provide an unfair advantage. Players wishing to use more than one item from the same category of peripherals must obtain permission from the Tournament's RC.

Using device drivers to pre-install prohibited macros on participants' devices (keyboards, mice or sound cards) is prohibited and may be regarded as cheating.

Equal technical conditions for the match are provided by the Organizer's game server. The Organizer does not compensate for differences in participants' personal equipment specifications or internet connection quality.

15. Conduct During Matches

During a match, only the five players registered for that match and the registered coach may join the team's voice channel (5 players + coach). Additional team staff may not join the channel during the match.

During a match, players may not use any external means of communication other than those provided by the Organizer. Unauthorized persons must not be present in the room from which a participant is playing and may not provide her with guidance during the match. Personal recording or streaming of a match is permitted only in accordance with Section 11 of this Rulebook.

Excessively loud background audio in the voice channel (such as music playback) and excessive profanity are prohibited.

Each participant must arrange her playing area so that she can play the match in full without interruptions not provided for in this Rulebook.

At the conclusion of the Tournament, players on prize-winning teams must take part in the award ceremony and interviews, where arranged by the Organizer.

Participants must comply with the Organizer's broadcast presentation and branding requirements: any materials relating to "WINIO CROWN SERIES" may include only marketing activities approved by the Organizer.

Match Rules

1. Game Version

The Tournament is played on the latest available version of the game client. If the latest version is deemed unsuitable for play due to bugs or significant changes introduced during or immediately before the Tournament, the Tournament Administration may require an earlier version to be used, provided that a rollback is possible.

Any game update during the Tournament may result in a rollback to the original version, where possible.

2. Match Format

Group Stage matches, quarterfinals and semifinals are played as best-of-three (Bo3) series, while the Grand Final is played as a best-of-five (Bo5) series. Nicknames and avatars must not directly and/or indirectly contain offensive and/or obscene language. Regulation time in a match consists of 24 rounds. If no winner is determined in regulation time (at a score of 12:12), overtime is played. Overtime uses the MR3 12.5K format.

Players are prohibited from using external software or hardware that affects the game. Any modifications that alter the game or give a player an advantage are strictly prohibited.

3. Rules of Conduct

As a condition of participation, players and other team members must observe generally accepted standards of behavior and refrain from offensive language, racism and the use of drugs or alcohol during the Tournament. The penalty for failing to comply with this section is specified in Section 4.2 of this Rulebook.

4. Match Preparation

Teams must complete the following steps when preparing for a match:

- Connect and check their own equipment (MANDATORY: headphones, mouse, keyboard and mouse pad)
- Test the equipment
- Join TeamSpeak and test the microphone

- Launch the game and test all settings

Steps to complete before the scheduled match start:

- Confirm that they have read this Rulebook in accordance with the procedure established by the Organizer.
- Launch the game, join the server and check all settings at least 10 minutes before the match starts.
- Close unrelated programs that are not required for the game and provide confirmation at a referee's request.
- Ensure that no unauthorized persons are present in the room during the match and remove anything not required for the game from the playing area.

All team players must be on the server 10 minutes before the match starts. Leaving the playing area or game server without permission from the Organizers or Referees is prohibited.

5. Game Server

Matches are played on servers provided by the Tournament Organizers. Teams must check all relevant aspects of the game, including loading errors, connection latency and similar issues, at least 10 minutes before the match starts.

If players fail to carry out these checks for reasons beyond the Tournament Organizers' control and allow the match to begin, both teams are deemed to have accepted the current state of the map and server, and the match will continue under those conditions.

6. Server Settings

- **Rounds:** first to 13 round wins (mp_maxrounds 24)
- **Round time:** 1 minute 55 seconds (mp_roundtime 1,92)
- **Starting money:** \$800 (mp_startmoney 800)
- **Maximum money:** \$16000 (mp_maxmoney 16000)
- **Freeze time:** 20 seconds (mp_freezetime 20)
- **Buy time after the round starts:** 20 seconds (mp_buytime 20)
- **Bomb timer:** 40 seconds (mp_c4timer 40)
- **Round restart delay:** 5 seconds (mp_round_restart_delay 5)

Overtime settings:

- **Overtime rounds:** first to 4 round wins (mp_overtime_maxrounds 6)
- **Overtime starting money:** \$12,500 (mp_overtime_startmoney 12 500)

7. In-Game Commands

In the event of a technical issue requiring a round to be restored using the backup function, players on the affected team must type "NL/No Live" in the chat.

8. CS2 Round Restore Function

- If a match is interrupted for reasons beyond the players' control (such as a server or player client crash), the Organizer will restore the round using CS2's backup and restore function. However, in certain cases listed below, a decision may be made to replay the round or the entire match:
- If an issue occurs before any damage is dealt or any significant gameplay takes place, the round must be restored, provided that the opponent and referee are notified immediately.
- If an issue occurs during a round after damage has been dealt and the outcome can still be determined (for example, one player disconnects while the others remain), the round will not be replayed or restored. The round will continue and its result will count. Special exceptions may be made if the damage is considered insignificant, such as accidental damage to a teammate at the start of the round, or if the damage was dealt by the team affected by the incident and requesting the round restore.
- If an issue occurs during a round after damage has been dealt and the outcome cannot be determined (for example, due to a server crash), the match is restored from the start of that round.
- If an issue occurs during a round after damage has been dealt and the outcome is clear (for example, one team is saving weapons and preserving health), but the round cannot continue (for example, due to a server crash), the round may be awarded to the team most likely to have won it.

Matches will not be stopped and/or rounds will not be restored or replayed where an incident is clearly the player's fault (for example, buying the wrong weapon).

9. Official Tournament Map Pool

Official competitive maps (Valve Active Duty map pool):

- Inferno

- Ancient
- Nuke
- Mirage
- Dust 2
- Anubis
- Cache

10. Map Veto Process

The map veto begins 15 (fifteen) minutes before the scheduled match start time. In the open qualifiers, the map veto is conducted on FACEIT.

For violations of the time limits set out in this section, referees apply Section 13.2.

The map selection process may be completed earlier, including substantially earlier, at the Organizers' request.

During map selection, the first choice communicated by a player to the Organizers is considered that player's ban or pick and may not be withdrawn.

No more than two representatives from each team may be present during the map veto.

11. Map Veto Procedure

The initial map selection order is determined by the VRS Global ranking with the female rosters filter applied. Each team chooses the starting side on the opponent's map pick. The starting sides on the final map are determined by a knife round.

Best-of-three (Bo3):

- Team A bans 1 map.
- Team B bans 1 map.
- Team A picks 1 map. Team B chooses the starting side.
- Team B picks 1 map. Team A chooses the starting side.
- Team A bans 1 map.
- Team B bans 1 map.
- The remaining map is played. A knife round determines the starting side.

12. Match Rules

All team players must be on the server 10 minutes before the match starts. Leaving the server without permission from the administrators or referees is prohibited.

Players are also prohibited from leaving the game server or voice channel without a Referee's permission during this period and throughout the match, except in cases of medical necessity or other circumstances approved by the Tournament Organizers.

12.1. Number of Players

All matches must start with five (5) players per team (5 vs. 5); no other combinations are permitted. If a team fails to field the required number of players, it is given a forfeit loss on the map.

12.2. Breaks Between Matches

Participants are given a 10-minute break between maps within a match. Participants are given a 45-minute break between series.

13. Use of the Pause Function

The pause function may be activated at any time, but takes effect only during the 20-second freeze time before the round begins. If a pause is activated during this 20-second countdown, it takes effect immediately. Otherwise, it takes effect during the next 20-second countdown before a round.

13.1. Technical Pauses

If a player experiences an issue that prevents them from continuing to play, they may use the pause function.

A technical pause can be called by typing ".tech". The player must state the reason for the pause before or immediately after pausing the match. During a technical pause, headphones must remain on the player's head and be switched on. Communication during such pauses is permitted only with the Tournament Organizers.

13.2. Tactical Timeouts

Each team may use up to three (3) tactical timeouts during regulation time on a map. Players may call a tactical timeout by typing '.tac' in the in-game chat.

Each tactical timeout lasts thirty (30) seconds. Players may use all tactical timeouts consecutively by calling each one separately after the previous timeout ends.

One additional timeout is granted in each overtime; unused tactical timeouts from regulation time do not carry over.

13.3. Pauses by the Tournament Organizers

The Tournament Organizer may pause the game directly or ask players to do so when necessary. Communication during such pauses is permitted only with referees and the Organizers.

14. Player Rules

14.1. Configuration Files

Configuration changes are permitted provided they do not give an unfair advantage comparable to cheating.

A player or team may be penalized for having prohibited settings in any configuration file, whether those settings are in use or merely stored in the relevant game folder.

Tournament players are advised to contact the Tournament Organizers if they are unsure whether particular settings are permitted or what they do.

14.2. Custom Files

Players are prohibited from using any custom game files during matches. Agent skins may not be changed.

Player agent skins may not be changed; only default skins are permitted. Any other modifications, including, but not limited to, the radar, interface and scoreboard, are strictly prohibited.

14.3. Renamed In-Game Items

Players may not use renamed in-game items that violate the rules of conduct applicable to in-game content.

14.4. In-Game Chat

Use of the in-game chat during a match is limited to communication with the Organizers.

Any advertising or irrelevant comments are prohibited before and after the match.

Penalties may be imposed if the in-game chat is used to annoy an opponent or disrupt play.

Communication with opponents before a match is permitted only in a respectful manner.

14.5. Use of "Bugs"

The deliberate use of any bugs, glitches or game errors is prohibited. The Organizers determine whether the use of such bugs affected the match and decide whether to award rounds or the match to the opponent, or to order a replay.

The following exploits are strictly prohibited. If a game bug is not listed here, the Tournament Administration will decide the consequences of its use on a case-by-case basis:

- Moving through inaccessible areas not intended by the map design, such as walls, ceilings or floors.
- Planting the bomb in a location where it cannot be defused.
- Planting the bomb in a way that makes its beeping or planting sound inaudible.
- Standing on teammates to see through, over or under solid objects, such as walls, boxes or ceilings, in a way not intended by the map design.
- "Pixel walking". A player is considered to be pixel walking when crouching or standing on invisible pixels on the map where there is no visible edge.
- Disrupting map elements by using objects, such as stopping the train on Overpass.

Players are advised to check with the Tournament Organizers whether a particular error, bug or glitch is considered prohibited.

The Tournament Organizers reserve the right to add further bugs to the list of permitted "bugs", retroactively or otherwise.

14.6. Reconnecting

Players may not reconnect to a match while a round is in progress. If a technical issue requires a reconnection, they must pause the game, state the

reason and only then reconnect. If a player leaves the server during a round, they must wait until the round ends and pause the game before reconnecting.

When reconnecting to the server, joining any team other than one's own is strictly prohibited.

Any violation of this rule will result in penalty points.

14.7. Prohibited Actions

The following actions are strictly prohibited during play and may result in the team's disqualification:

- Any actions directly contrary to this Rulebook or the game's user agreement.
- Betting on Tournament matches.
- Sharing server details with third parties.
- Using scripts, bugs, glitches or errors in the game or map.
- Moving through walls, floors or roofs, or "skywalking".
- Installing or using SweetFX or SkinChanger.
- Planting the bomb so that it cannot be defused, such as in locations with transparent textures.
- Using "flash bugs".
- "Pixel walking".
- Using 16-bit graphics settings.
- Using any third-party software not authorized by the game publisher that provides an unfair advantage (treated as cheating).
- Allowing unauthorized persons to be present in the game.
- Insulting opponents, teammates, the Administration or other participants.
- Unsportsmanlike conduct, as determined by the match referee or Head Referee, including watching the match broadcast and receiving outside assistance.
- Transferring an account or using someone else's account.
- Opening third-party applications, browsers or streams during play, other than the CS2 client, TeamSpeak and required drivers.

15. Rule Changes

The Tournament Organizer and the RC, "WINIO Referee Committee", reserve the right to change, remove or otherwise amend the rules without prior notice, and to rule on situations not covered by this Rulebook in order to preserve the spirit of the Tournament and competitive integrity.

Latest version of the rules: 30.09.2026